Ceasefire with Pakistan

In November 2003, four years after the Kargil War, Pakistan and India had entered into a ceasefire agreement for areas astride the LC in J & K. The year 2002 had seen upward of 8000 ceasefire violations (CFV), which did little to promote a sense of security, so essential for prosperity and development in the region. It was hoped that this would herald a new era of peace and goodwill between the two nations. After an initial good start and strict observance for about four years, the violations recommenced in 2007 and continued showing an upward trend thereafter, with the number of CFVs reaching their pre-2003 levels by 2020, with about 400 to 450 violations every month.[5] The ceasefire was being honoured more in the breach, with small arms, mortar and artillery fire an almost daily occurrence.

The reason for the CFVs was clearly to provide covering fire to infiltrating terrorist groups. Crossing of the LC was when the terrorists were most vulnerable. Once they crossed over and reached the border villages or population centres further to the rear, they could mingle with the population and seek safe havens with local sympathizers and over ground workers (OGWs). Targeting the terrorists as they attempted to infiltrate and eliminating them ahead of the AIOS was the most preferred and tactically viable option. The full range of weapons could be used, with no fear of collateral damage. Violations were not only limited to fire assaults but also through physical raids on vulnerable border outposts. In several such instances, Border Action Teams (BATs) of the Pakistan Army comprising their SSG personnel had carried out cross-border raids, and in some cases, even severing the heads of our soldiers in the most horrific and barbarous manner. Obviously, there was no love lost on either side and units would always be thirsting for revenge.

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